

STATE OF OKLAHOMA

2nd Session of the 60th Legislature (2026)

CONFERENCE COMMITTEE
SUBSTITUTE
FOR ENGROSSED
HOUSE BILL NO. 3021

By: Lowe of the House

and

Pugh of the Senate

CONFERENCE COMMITTEE SUBSTITUTE

An Act relating to schools; amending 70 O.S. 2021, Section 11-103.6, as last amended by Section 1, Chapter 264, O.S.L. 2024 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 11-103.6), which relates to curriculum requirements for graduation; defining terms; expanding requirements to include certain units or sets of competencies; prohibiting certain diploma pathway from being available to certain students; directing the State Department of Education to develop and distribute certain notice; allowing certain seminar to fulfill certain English requirement; allowing certain indigenous language to fulfill certain world language requirement; allowing certain course to fulfill certain personal financial literacy requirement; adding certain mathematics course for alternate diploma beginning in certain school year; removing language allowing certain core curriculum courses to fulfill certain alternate diploma requirement; allowing certain students to use certain courses to fulfill certain diploma requirements; requiring school districts to offer sufficient courses for students to meet certain requirements; directing certain sequence of units or sets of competencies to be recommended by the State Board of Education, the State Board of Career and Technology Education, and the Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education; requiring the State Department of Education's Accreditation Office, in certain consultation, to develop and publish certain

1 guidelines and certain standardized form; providing
2 for contents of form; requiring submission of form
3 annually by certain date; requiring the Department to
4 provide certain feedback and recommendations within
5 certain time period; allowing the Oklahoma Department
6 of Career and Technology Education to submit certain
7 waiver for program and coursework approval or
8 disapproval; requiring certain framework to be
9 available on the State Department of Education's
10 website; directing the Oklahoma Workforce Commission,
11 in certain coordination, to develop certain catalog
12 for diploma recipients; requiring production of
13 certain catalog by certain school year; requiring
14 biannual update to certain catalog; delaying required
15 submission of certain plan; requiring plan to include
16 certain information; conforming language; updating
17 statutory language; updating statutory references;
18 amending 70 O.S. 2021, Section 11-103.6f, which
19 relates to graduation requirement exceptions;
20 allowing a school district board of education to
21 waive certain graduation requirement for certain
22 students who complete certain project or write
23 certain paper; repealing 70 O.S. 2021, Section 11-
24 103.6, as last amended by Section 166, Chapter 452,
O.S.L. 2024 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 11-103.6),
which relates to curriculum requirements for
graduation; repealing 70 O.S. 2021, Section 11-103.6,
as last amended by Section 1, Chapter 384, O.S.L.
2024 (70 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 11-103.6), which
relates to curriculum requirements for graduation;
providing an effective date; and declaring an
emergency.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

SECTION 1. AMENDATORY 70 O.S. 2021, Section 11-103.6, as
last amended by Section 1, Chapter 264, O.S.L. 2024 (70 O.S. Supp.
2025, Section 11-103.6), is amended to read as follows:

1 Section 11-103.6. A. 1. The State Board of Education shall
2 adopt subject matter standards for instruction of students in the
3 public schools of this state that are necessary to ensure there is
4 attainment of desired levels of competencies in a variety of areas
5 to include language, mathematics, science, social studies,
6 communication, and health and physical education.

7 2. School districts shall develop and implement curriculum,
8 courses and instruction in order to ensure that students meet the
9 skills and competencies as set forth in this section and in the
10 subject matter standards adopted by the State Board of Education.

11 3. All students shall gain literacy at the elementary and
12 secondary levels. Students shall develop skills in reading,
13 writing, speaking, computing and critical thinking. For purposes of
14 this section, critical thinking means a manner of analytical
15 thinking which is logical and uses linear factual analysis to reach
16 a conclusion. They shall learn about cultures and environments -
17 their own and those of others with whom they share the earth. All
18 students shall receive the instruction needed to lead healthy and
19 physically active lifestyles. Students, therefore, shall study
20 social studies, literature, languages, the arts, health, mathematics
21 and science. Such curricula shall provide for the teaching of a
22 hands-on career exploration program in cooperation with technology
23 center schools.

1 4. The subject matter standards shall be designed to teach the
2 competencies for which students shall be tested as provided in
3 Section 1210.508 of this title, and shall be designed to prepare all
4 students for active citizenship, employment and/or successful
5 completion of postsecondary education without the need for remedial
6 coursework at the postsecondary level.

7 5. The subject matter standards shall be designed with rigor as
8 defined in paragraph 3 9 of subsection 6 B of this section.

9 6. The subject matter standards for English Language Arts shall
10 give Classic Literature and nonfiction literature equal
11 consideration to other literature. In addition, emphasis shall be
12 given to the study of complete works of literature.

13 7. At a minimum, the subject matter standards for mathematics
14 shall require mastery of the standard algorithms in mathematics,
15 which is the most logical, efficient way of solving a problem that
16 consistently works, and for students to attain fluency in Euclidian
17 geometry.

18 8. The subject matter standards for history, social studies and
19 United States Government shall include study of important historical
20 documents, including the United States Constitution, Declaration of
21 Independence, Emancipation Proclamation, Federalist Papers and other
22 documents with significant history and heritage of the United
23 States, and the content of the United States naturalization test,
24 with an emphasis on the specific content of the test and the ideas

1 and concepts it references. Beginning with the 2022-2023 school
2 year, the United States naturalization test shall be administered in
3 accordance with subsection ~~F~~ G of this section.

4 9. The subject matter standards for United States Government
5 shall include an emphasis on civics, the structure and relationship
6 between the national, state, county and local governments and
7 simulations of the democratic process. For the purposes of this
8 section, "civics" means the study of the rights and duties of
9 Oklahoma and United States citizens and of how those governments
10 work.

11 10. The subject matter standards for health and physical
12 education shall include but not be limited to the domains of
13 physical, emotional, social and intellectual health. Health
14 literacy shall include the ability to obtain, process and understand
15 basic health information and services needed to make appropriate
16 health decisions. Health shall also include the importance of
17 proper nutrition and exercise, mental health and wellness, substance
18 abuse, coping skills for understanding and managing trauma,
19 establishing and maintaining positive relationships and responsible
20 decision making. Physical literacy shall include the ability to
21 move with competence and confidence in a wide variety of physical
22 activities in multiple environments that benefit the healthy
23 development of the whole person.

24 B. For purposes of this section:

1 1. "Applied knowledge of content" means an educational approach
2 which aids students in connecting standards-based learning with
3 concepts across different subjects for a better understanding of the
4 real-world relevance of the subject matter to enhance critical
5 thinking, improve knowledge retention of the standard and encourage
6 creativity;

7 2. "Approved for college admission requirements" means courses
8 which are approved by the Oklahoma State Regents for Higher
9 Education for admission to an institution within The Oklahoma State
10 System of Higher Education;

11 3. "Contextual methodology" means academic content and skills
12 taught by utilizing real-world problems and projects in a way that
13 helps students understand the application of that knowledge;

14 4. "Locally approved" means a course that has received approval
15 by the local school district board of education and has submitted a
16 nonstandard course waiver notifying the State Department of
17 Education;

18 5. "Math-based application course" means a course that teaches
19 math content with a real-world application;

20 6. "Nonstandard course waiver" means the official process which
21 allows a local school district to offer a course for graduation
22 credit that does not fully align with a single set of Oklahoma
23 Academic Standards allowing for flexibility among districts
24

1 throughout the state while notifying the appropriate statewide
2 systems;

3 7. "Pathway unit" means a course taken by a high school student
4 that is aligned with the student's current Individualized Career and
5 Academic Plan (ICAP);

6 8. "Qualified agricultural education courses" means courses
7 that have been determined by the State Board of Education to offer
8 the sets of competencies for one or more science content areas and
9 which correspond to academic science courses. Qualified
10 agricultural education courses shall include, but are not limited
11 to, horticulture, plant and soil science, natural resources and
12 environmental science, and animal science. The courses shall be
13 taught by teachers certified in agricultural education and comply
14 with all rules of the Oklahoma Department of Career and Technology
15 Education;

16 9. "Rigor" means a level of difficulty that is thorough,
17 exhaustive and accurate and is appropriate for the grade level;

18 10. "Science-based application course" means a course that
19 teaches science content with a real-world application;

20 11. "Sets of competencies" means instruction in those skills
21 and competencies that are specified in the subject matter standards
22 adopted by the State Board of Education and other skills and
23 competencies adopted by the Board, without regard to specified
24 instructional time; and

1 12. "Unit" means a Carnegie Unit as defined by the North
2 Central Association's Commission on Schools.

3 C. Beginning with students entering the eighth grade in the
4 2025-2026 school year, in order to graduate from a public high
5 school accredited by the State Board of Education with a standard
6 college-ready and career-ready diploma, students shall complete a
7 minimum of the following twenty-three (23) curriculum units or sets
8 of competencies at the secondary level; beginning with the 2024-2025
9 school year, with the approval of a parent or legal guardian and
10 subject to school guidance, students may optionally complete the
11 requirements in this subsection in lieu of subsection D of this
12 section to receive a college-ready and career-ready standard
13 diploma.

14 1. Courses required for credit for high school graduation under
15 this subsection shall also be approved for college admissions
16 requirements;

17 2. Four units or sets of competencies of English to include
18 Grammar, Composition, Literature, an Advanced Placement English
19 Seminar, or any English course approved for college admission
20 requirements;

21 3. Four units or sets of competencies of mathematics, two of
22 which shall include Algebra I and either Algebra II or Geometry.
23 The other two units may include Algebra II, Geometry, Trigonometry,
24 Math Analysis, Calculus, Statistics, Math of Finance, Computer

Science, college courses approved for dual credit, a full-time postsecondary career and technology program that teaches math content with a real-world application, or locally approved math-based application course, or any mathematics course with applied knowledge of content and rigor above Algebra I. For the purposes of this section, a full-time postsecondary career and technology program that teaches math content with a real-world application shall not include courses categorized as Arts, A/V Technology and Communications, Education and Training, Hospitality and Tourism, or Human Services, including, but not limited to: Barbering, Cosmetology, Culinary Arts, Esthetician, Event Management, Horticulture, or Hospitality Management;

4. Three units or sets of competencies of laboratory science requirements including one unit or set of competencies of life science meeting the standards for Biology I; one unit or set of competencies of physical science meeting the standards for Physical Science, Chemistry, or Physics; and one unit or set of competencies from the domains of physical science, life science, or earth and space science, or full-time postsecondary career and technology program that teaches science content with a real-world application or locally approved science based application course, or any science course with applied knowledge of content and rigor above Biology I or Physical Science. For the purposes of this section, a full-time postsecondary career and technology program that teaches science

1 content with a real-world application shall not include courses
2 categorized as Arts, A/V Technology and Communications, Education
3 and Training, Hospitality and Tourism, or Human Services, including,
4 but not limited to: Barbering, Cosmetology, Culinary Arts,
5 Esthetician, Event Management, or Hospitality Management;

6 5. Three units or sets of competencies of history and
7 citizenship skills including one unit of American History, one-half
8 unit of Oklahoma History, one-half unit of United States Government,
9 and one unit from the subjects of History, Government, Geography,
10 Economics, Civics, or non-Western culture;

11 6. Six pathway units or sets of competencies approved at the
12 discretion of the school district board of education which align
13 with each student's Individual Career and Academic Plan (ICAP) and
14 may include, but are not limited to, any additional units or sets of
15 competencies as provided in paragraphs 2 through 5 of this
16 subsection, world language, indigenous language spoken in North
17 America, or non-English language, computer technology, Junior
18 Reserve Officers' Training Corps (JROTC), internship or
19 apprenticeship programs, career and technology education courses,
20 concurrently enrolled courses, Advanced Placement courses,
21 International Baccalaureate courses, music, art, drama, speech,
22 dance, media arts, or other approved courses;

23 7. One-half (1/2) unit or set of competencies of personal
24 financial literacy, as provided in the Passport to Financial

Literacy Act, whether taught as an elective course or when taught during instruction as provided in and subject to the standards of subsection A of Section 11-103.6h of this title in coursework offered by the school district or partnering technology center school by a teacher certified in a relevant secondary subject area and taken in the tenth, eleventh, or twelfth grade. The one-half (1/2) unit in personal financial literacy required under this paragraph may be fulfilled through an Advanced Placement (AP) course whose content substantially addresses the required concepts;

8. Three units or sets of competencies of elective courses locally approved by the school district board of education; and

9. At least two additional units or sets of competencies from paragraph 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, or 8 which are required to be approved for college admissions by the State Regents for Higher Education when the student is enrolled in the eighth grade, or at any time thereafter when the student completes the course, but prior to graduation.

D. Subject to the provisions of subsection ~~E~~ E of this section, in order to graduate from a public high school accredited by the State Board of Education with a standard college-ready and career-ready diploma, students enrolled in grades eight through twelve in the 2024-2025 school year shall complete the ~~following college preparatory/work-ready~~ curriculum units or sets of competencies listed in paragraphs 1 through 8 of this subsection at the secondary

1 ~~level~~. This subsection shall be unavailable as a diploma pathway
2 to students not enrolled in a public high school accredited by the
3 State Board of Education prior to the 2025-2026 school year for the
4 completion of their diploma, and who have not previously started the
5 pathway provided in this subsection. The State Department of
6 Education shall develop and distribute to school districts a notice
7 suitable for the purposes of notifying parents and legal guardians
8 that this degree pathway is being terminated in the 2029-2030 school
9 year, and students who were not already on the pathway prior to the
10 2025-2026 school year shall not be eligible for this pathway, and
11 shall be subject to the requirements in subsection C of this
12 section.

13 1. Four units or sets of competencies of English to include
14 Grammar, Composition, Literature, an Advanced Placement English
15 Seminar, or any English course approved for college admission
16 requirements;

17 2. Three units or sets of competencies of mathematics, limited
18 to Algebra I, Algebra II, Geometry, Trigonometry, Math Analysis,
19 Calculus, Advanced Placement Statistics, or any mathematics course
20 with applied knowledge of content ~~and/or~~ and rigor above Algebra I
21 and approved for college admission requirements;

22 3. Three units or sets of competencies of laboratory science
23 approved for college admission requirements including one unit or
24 set of competencies of life science meeting the standards for

1 Biology I; one unit or set of competencies of physical science,
2 meeting the standards for Physical Science, Chemistry or Physics;
3 and one unit or set of competencies from the domains of physical
4 science, life science, or earth and space science such that the
5 applied knowledge of content and rigor is above Biology I or
6 Physical Science;

7 4. Three units or sets of competencies of history and
8 citizenship skills, including one unit of American History, one-half
9 unit of Oklahoma History, one-half unit of United States Government
10 and one unit from the subjects of History, Government, Geography,
11 Economics, Civics, or non-Western culture and approved for college
12 admission requirements;

13 5. Two units or sets of competencies of the same world
14 language, indigenous language spoken in North America, or non-
15 English language or two units of computer technology approved for
16 college admission requirements, whether taught at a high school or a
17 technology center school, including computer programming, hardware,
18 and business computer applications, such as word processing,
19 databases, spreadsheets, and graphics, excluding keyboarding or
20 typing courses;

21 6. One additional unit or set of competencies selected from
22 paragraphs 1 through 5 of this subsection or career and technology
23 education courses, concurrently enrolled courses, Advanced Placement
24

1 courses or International Baccalaureate courses approved for college
2 admission requirements;

3 7. One-half (1/2) unit or set of competencies of personal
4 financial literacy, as provided in the Passport to Financial
5 Literacy Act, whether taught as an elective course or when taught
6 during instruction as provided in and subject to the standards of
7 subsection A of Section 11-103.6h of this title in coursework
8 offered by the school district or partnering technology center
9 school by a teacher certified in a relevant secondary subject area
10 and taken in the tenth, eleventh, or twelfth grade. The one-half
11 (1/2) unit in personal financial literacy required under this
12 paragraph may be fulfilled through an Advanced Placement (AP) course
13 whose content substantially addresses the required concepts; and

14 8. One unit or set of competencies of fine arts, such as music,
15 art, or drama, or one unit or set of competencies of speech.

16 ~~C.~~ E. In lieu of the requirements of subsection ~~B~~ D of this
17 section which requires a college preparatory/work ready curriculum,
18 a student who was enrolled in grades eight through twelve in the
19 2024-2025 school year may enroll in the core curriculum as provided
20 in ~~subsection D of this section~~ subsection upon written approval of
21 the parent or legal guardian of the student. For students under the
22 age of eighteen (18) school districts shall require a parent or
23 legal guardian of the student to meet with a designee of the school
24 prior to enrollment in the core curriculum. This subsection shall

1 be unavailable as a diploma pathway to students not enrolled in a
2 public high school accredited by the State Board of Education prior
3 to the 2025-2026 school year. The State Department of Education
4 shall develop and distribute to school districts a form suitable for
5 this purpose, which shall include information on the benefits to
6 students of completing the college preparatory/work ready curriculum
7 as provided for in subsection ~~B~~ D of this section.

8 ~~D. For those students subject to the requirements of subsection~~
9 ~~C of this section, in~~ In order to graduate from a public high school
10 accredited by the State Board of Education with a standard diploma,
11 students who were enrolled in grades eight through twelve in the
12 2024-2025 school year shall complete the following core curriculum
13 units or sets of competencies at the secondary level:

14 1. Language Arts - Four units or sets of competencies, to
15 consist of one unit or set of competencies of grammar and
16 composition, and three units or sets of competencies which may
17 include, but are not limited to, the following courses:

- 18 a. American Literature,
- 19 b. English Literature,
- 20 c. World Literature,
- 21 d. Advanced English Courses, or
- 22 e. other English courses with applied knowledge of
23 content ~~and/or~~ and rigor equal to or above grammar and
24 composition;

1 2. Mathematics - Three units or sets of competencies to consist
2 of one unit or set of competencies of Algebra I or Algebra I taught
3 in a contextual methodology, and two units or sets of competencies
4 which may include, but are not limited to, the following courses:

- 5 a. Algebra II,
- 6 b. Geometry or Geometry taught in a contextual
7 methodology,
- 8 c. Trigonometry,
- 9 d. Math Analysis or Precalculus,
- 10 e. Calculus,
- 11 f. Statistics and/or Probability,
- 12 g. Computer Science or acceptance and successful
13 completion of one (1) year of a full-time, three-hour
14 career and technology program leading to an industry
15 credential/certificate or college credit. The State
16 Board of Career and Technology Education shall
17 promulgate rules to define the provisions of this
18 section related to the accepted industry-valued
19 credentials which are industry-endorsed or industry-
20 aligned. The list of accepted industry-valued
21 credentials shall be reviewed annually and updated at
22 least every three (3) years by the Board,
- 23 h. (1) contextual mathematics courses which enhance
24 technology preparation, or

1 (2) a science, technology, engineering and math
2 (STEM) block course meeting the requirements for
3 course competencies listed in paragraph 2 of
4 subsection ~~B~~ D of this section, whether taught at
5 a:

6 (a) comprehensive high school, or

7 (b) technology center school when taken in the
8 tenth, eleventh or twelfth grade, taught by
9 a certified teacher, and approved by the
10 State Board of Education and the independent
11 district board of education,

12 i. mathematics courses taught at a technology center
13 school by a teacher certified in the secondary subject
14 area when taken in the tenth, eleventh or twelfth
15 grade upon approval of the State Board of Education
16 and the independent district board of education, or

17 j. any other mathematics course with applied knowledge of
18 content ~~and/or~~ and rigor equal to or above Algebra I;

19 3. Science - Three units or sets of competencies to consist of
20 one unit or set of competencies of Biology I or Biology I taught in
21 a contextual methodology, and two units or sets of competencies in
22 the areas of life, physical, or earth science or technology which
23 may include, but are not limited to, the following courses:

24 a. Chemistry I,

- b. Physics,
- c. Biology II,
- d. Chemistry II,
- e. Physical Science,
- f. Earth Science,
- g. Botany,
- h. Zoology,
- i. Anatomy and Physiology,
- j. Astronomy,
- k. Applied Biology/Chemistry,
- l. Applied Physics,
- m. Principles of Technology,
- n. qualified agricultural education courses,
- o. (1) contextual science courses which enhance
technology preparation, or
(2) a science, technology, engineering and math
(STEM) block course meeting the requirements for
course competencies listed in paragraph 3 of
subsection ~~B~~ D of this section, whether taught at
a:
 - (a) comprehensive high school, or
 - (b) technology center school when taken in the
tenth, eleventh or twelfth grade, taught by
a certified teacher, and approved by the

State Board of Education and the independent
district board of education,

- p. science courses taught at a technology center school
by a teacher certified in the secondary subject area
when taken in the tenth, eleventh or twelfth grade
upon approval of the State Board of Education and the
independent district board of education, or
- q. other science courses with applied knowledge of
content ~~and/or~~ and rigor equal to or above Biology I;

4. Social Studies - Three units or sets of competencies, to
consist of one unit or set of competencies of United States History,
one-half (1/2) to one unit or set of competencies of United States
Government, one-half (1/2) unit or set of competencies of Oklahoma
History, and one-half (1/2) to one unit or set of competencies which
may include, but are not limited to, the following courses:

- a. World History,
- b. Geography,
- c. Economics,
- d. Anthropology, or
- e. other social studies courses with applied knowledge of
content ~~and/or~~ and rigor equal to or above United
States History, United States Government, and Oklahoma
History;

1 5. Arts - One unit or set of competencies which may include,
2 but is not limited to, courses in Visual Arts and General Music;

3 6. One-half (1/2) unit or set of competencies of personal
4 financial literacy, as provided in the Passport to Financial
5 Literacy Act, whether taught as an elective course or when taught
6 during instruction as provided in and subject to the standards of
7 subsection A of Section 11-103.6h of this title in coursework
8 offered by the school district or partnering technology center
9 school by a teacher certified in a relevant secondary subject area
10 and taken in the tenth, eleventh, or twelfth grade. The one-half
11 (1/2) unit in personal financial literacy required under this
12 paragraph may be fulfilled through an Advanced Placement (AP) course
13 whose content substantially addresses the required concepts; and

14 7. Computer Education or World Language - One unit or set of
15 competencies of computer technology, whether taught at a high school
16 or a technology center school, including computer programming,
17 hardware and business computer applications, such as word
18 processing, databases, spreadsheets and graphics, excluding
19 keyboarding or typing courses, or one unit or set of competencies of
20 world language, indigenous language spoken in North America, or non-
21 English language.

22 ~~E.~~ F. 1. A school district may issue an alternate diploma to a
23 student who meets the definition of a student with the most
24 significant cognitive disabilities and who participates in the

1 Oklahoma Alternate Assessment Program (OAAP) beginning in the 2023-
2 2024 school year. An alternate diploma shall be standards-based,
3 aligned with requirements for a standard diploma in subsection C, D,
4 or E of this section, and obtained by the school year in which a
5 student turns twenty-two (22) years of age.

6 ~~F.~~ 2. An alternate diploma issued in accordance with this
7 subsection shall not terminate a Free and Appropriate Public
8 Education (FAPE) for students with an Individualized Education
9 Program (IEP) unless they reach the maximum age of FAPE. The IEP
10 team shall determine subsequent courses and services for students
11 participating in OAAP who receive an alternate diploma under this
12 subsection.

13 ~~G.~~ 3. Students participating in the OAAP shall not be precluded
14 from attempting to meet the requirements of a standard diploma
15 program under this section, and participation in the OAAP shall be
16 assessed by alternative achievement standards that promote access to
17 and progress in the general education curriculum, and shall not
18 determine a student's educational setting under the Individuals with
19 Disabilities Education Act (IDEA).

20 ~~H.~~ 4. Students who meet requirements for an alternate diploma
21 under this section may count as having received a standard diploma
22 for purposes of calculating and reporting the adjusted cohort
23 graduation rate (ACGR).
24

~~1.~~ 5. A student may be awarded an alternate diploma upon completion of the following curriculum units or sets of competencies at the secondary level consistent with the academic plan of the student:

~~1.~~

a. Language Arts - Four units or sets of competencies based on alternate academic achievement standards to consist of reading literature, reading informational text, writing, speaking and listening, and language in the following courses:

~~a.~~

(1) English 1 Alternate,

~~b.~~

(2) English 2 Alternate,

~~c.~~

(3) English 3 Alternate, and

~~d.~~

(4) English 4 Alternate~~1,~~

~~2.~~

b. (1) Mathematics - For students enrolled in grades eight through twelve in the 2024-2025 school year and attending a public high school accredited by the State Board of Education prior to the 2025-2026 school year: Three units or sets of

competencies based on alternate academic achievement standards to consist of number, quantities, algebra, functions/statistics, probability, and geometry in the following courses:

~~a.~~

(a) Math Alternate 1,

~~b.~~

(b) Math Alternate 2, and

~~c.~~

(c) Math Alternate 3~~+~~,

(2) Mathematics - Beginning with students entering the eighth grade in the 2025-2026 school year: Four units or sets of competencies based on alternate academic achievement standards to consist of number, quantities, algebra, functions/statistics, probability, and geometry in the following courses:

(a) Math Alternate 1,

(b) Math Alternate 2,

(c) Math Alternate 3, and

(d) Math Alternate 4,

~~3.~~

c. Science - Three units or sets of competencies based on alternate academic achievement standards to consist of life science, physical science, and earth science in the following courses:

a.

(1) Life Science Alternate,

b.

(2) Physical Science Alternate, and

c.

(3) Earth Science Alternate~~1~~

~~4.~~

d. Social Studies - Three units or sets of competencies based on alternate academic achievement standards to consist of United States History, United States Government, Oklahoma History, Geography, and Social Studies in the following courses:

a.

(1) Social Studies Alternate 1,

b.

(2) Social Studies Alternate 2, and

c.

(3) Social Studies Alternate 3~~1~~

~~5.~~

1 e. Arts - One unit or set of competencies which may
2 include, but is not limited to, courses in Visual Arts
3 and General Music~~†~~,

4 ~~6.~~

5 f. Computer Education or World Language - One unit or set
6 of competencies of computer technology, whether taught
7 at a high school or a technology center school,
8 including computer programming, hardware, and business
9 computer applications, such as word processing,
10 databases, spreadsheets, and graphics, excluding
11 keyboarding or typing courses, or one unit or set of
12 competencies of world language, indigenous language
13 spoken in North America or non-English language~~†~~,

14 ~~7.~~

15 g. Career Readiness - at least two units of Career
16 Readiness, including Career Readiness I, Career
17 Readiness II, Career Readiness III, or Career
18 Readiness IV. Each Career Readiness course may be
19 substituted for Careers/Exploration, Internship I, or
20 Internship II~~†~~and,

21 ~~8.~~

22 h. Life Skills - at least two units of Life Skills, such
23 as Life Skills I, Life Skills II, Life Skills III, or
24 Life Skills IV. Each Life Skills course may be

1 substituted for the Life Skills or Family and Consumer
2 Science courses~~-, and~~

3 ~~J. Courses in the core curriculum may be used as a substitute~~
4 ~~for corresponding courses required by the alternate diploma. Other~~
5 ~~courses may be substituted as determined by the State Board of~~
6 ~~Education.~~

7 ~~K. 1. In addition to the curriculum requirements of either~~
8 ~~subsection B or D of this section, in order to graduate from a~~
9 ~~public high school accredited by the State Board of Education~~
10 ~~students shall complete any additional course requirements or~~
11 ~~recommended elective courses as may be established by the State~~
12 ~~Board of Education and the district school board. School districts~~
13 ~~shall strongly encourage students to complete two units or sets of~~
14 ~~competencies of world languages and two units or sets of~~
15 ~~competencies of physical and health education.~~

16 ~~2. No student shall receive credit for high school graduation~~
17 ~~more than once for completion of the same unit or set of~~
18 ~~competencies to satisfy the curriculum requirements of this section.~~

19 ~~3. A school district shall not be required to offer every~~
20 ~~course listed in subsections B and D of this section but shall offer~~
21 ~~sufficient courses to allow a student to meet the graduation~~
22 ~~requirements during the secondary grade years of the student.~~

23 ~~L.~~

1 i. any course available at the school consistent with the
2 student's academic plan may be used as corresponding
3 courses required for a student participating in OAAP
4 to achieve a diploma. Other courses may be locally
5 approved.

6 G. 1. In addition to the curriculum requirements of either
7 subsection ~~B or~~ C, D, or E of this section, beginning with ninth
8 graders in the 2021-22 school year, in order to graduate from a
9 public high school accredited by the State Board of Education,
10 students shall pass the United States naturalization test pursuant
11 to the provisions of this subsection.

12 2. School districts shall offer the United States
13 naturalization test to students at least once per school year,
14 beginning as early as eighth grade at the discretion of the school
15 district; provided, any student may retake the exam upon request,
16 and as often as desired, until earning a passing score. For
17 purposes of this subsection, a passing score shall be 60 out of 100
18 questions.

19 3. School districts shall exempt students with disabilities
20 whose individualized education program (IEP), consistent with state
21 and federal law, indicates that the student is to be assessed with
22 alternate achievement standards through the OAAP.

23 ~~M. For purposes of this section:~~
24

1 ~~1. "Contextual methodology" means academic content and skills~~
2 ~~taught by utilizing real-world problems and projects in a way that~~
3 ~~helps students understand the application of that knowledge;~~

4 ~~2. "Qualified agricultural education courses" means courses~~
5 ~~that have been determined by the State Board of Education to offer~~
6 ~~the sets of competencies for one or more science content areas and~~
7 ~~which correspond to academic science courses. Qualified~~
8 ~~agricultural education courses shall include, but are not limited~~
9 ~~to, Horticulture, Plant and Soil Science, Natural Resources and~~
10 ~~Environmental Science, and Animal Science. The courses shall be~~
11 ~~taught by teachers certified in agricultural education and comply~~
12 ~~with all rules of the Oklahoma Department of Career and Technology~~
13 ~~Education;~~

14 ~~3. "Rigor" means a level of difficulty that is thorough,~~
15 ~~exhaustive and accurate and is appropriate for the grade level;~~

16 ~~4. "Sets of competencies" means instruction in those skills and~~
17 ~~competencies that are specified in the subject matter standards~~
18 ~~adopted by the State Board of Education and other skills and~~
19 ~~competencies adopted by the Board, without regard to specified~~
20 ~~instructional time; and~~

21 ~~5. "Unit" means a Carnegie Unit as defined by the North Central~~
22 ~~Association's Commission on Schools.~~

23 In addition to the curriculum requirements of subsection C, D,
24 or E of this section, in order to graduate from a public high school

1 accredited by the State Board of Education, students shall complete
2 the requirements for a personal financial literacy passport as set
3 forth in the Passport to Financial Literacy Act and any additional
4 course requirements or recommended elective courses as may be
5 established by the State Board of Education and the district school
6 board.

7 5. The one-half (1/2) unit or set of competencies in personal
8 financial literacy required in subsection C, D, or E of this section
9 shall be completed in the tenth, eleventh, or twelfth grade to
10 fulfill the requirements for graduation.

11 6. A school district shall not be required to offer every
12 course listed in subsections C, D, and E of this section but
13 districts shall offer sufficient courses to allow students to meet
14 the graduation requirements and ensure the student meets the
15 coursework requirements established for Oklahoma's Promise by the
16 Oklahoma State Regents of Higher Education.

17 7. No student shall receive credit for high school graduation
18 more than once for completion of the same unit or set of
19 competencies to satisfy the curriculum requirements of this section.

20 8. All units or sets of competencies required for graduation
21 may be taken in any sequence recommended by the school district, the
22 State Board of Education, State Board of Career and Technology
23 Education, and State Regents for Higher Education.

1 9. As a condition of receiving accreditation from the State
2 Board of Education, all students in grades nine through twelve shall
3 enroll in a minimum of six periods, or the equivalent in block
4 scheduling or other scheduling structure, consistent with and
5 meeting minimum school day and hour requirements as prescribed by
6 state law, that allows for instruction in sets of competencies, of
7 rigorous academic, concurrent enrollment, apprenticeships, and
8 rigorous vocational courses each day, which may include arts, vocal
9 and instrumental music, speech classes, and physical education
10 classes.

11 10. The units or sets of competencies in mathematics required
12 in subsection C, D, or E of this section shall be completed in the
13 eighth through twelfth grades. If a student completes any required
14 courses or sets of competencies in mathematics prior to eighth
15 grade, the student may take any other mathematics courses or sets of
16 competencies to fulfill the requirement to complete the units or
17 sets of competencies in grades eight through twelve after the
18 student has satisfied the requirements of subsection C, D, or E of
19 this section.

20 11. Credit for the units or sets of competencies required in
21 subsection C, D, or E of this section shall be given when such units
22 or sets of competencies are taken prior to ninth grade if the
23 teachers are certified or authorized to teach the subjects for high
24 school credit and the required rigor is maintained.

1 12. A school district shall determine the specific description
2 of the locally approved math- and science-based application courses
3 allowed pursuant to paragraphs 2 and 3 of subsection D of this
4 section. Formal notification with the specific course description
5 shall be provided to the State Department of Education prior to July
6 1 of each school year. The notification shall include what courses
7 will be coded as locally approved math- and science-based
8 application courses for the ensuing school year.

9 H. 1. The State Department of Education's Accreditation
10 Office, in consultation with the Oklahoma Department of Career and
11 Technology Education and the Oklahoma State Regents for Higher
12 Education, shall develop and publish guidelines for local curriculum
13 development, and a standardized form for submission for notification
14 and review. The form shall be called a Nonstandard Course Waiver
15 for the purposes of reviewing and standardizing the rigor of courses
16 locally approved by public school district boards of education. The
17 Nonstandard Course Waiver shall require, at minimum, the following
18 information:

- 19 a. name of the course to be considered,
 - 20 b. specific description,
 - 21 c. learning objectives,
 - 22 d. a course syllabus,
- 23
- 24

- e. a crosswalk of the course syllabus and objectives to the appropriate course or courses' Oklahoma Academic Standards,
- f. proposed credit to be granted for the course, and
- g. date and vote of approval by the local district school board.

2. Courses shall be presented to local district boards of education utilizing the Nonstandard Course Waiver, and any additional information required by the appropriate local boards.

3. The Nonstandard Course Waiver shall be submitted to the State Department of Education's Accreditation Office no later than March 1 annually for new locally approved courses. Courses locally approved by local school district boards of education shall be reviewed for completion by the State Department of Education's Accreditation Office. Locally approved courses with changes to the student learning outcomes in the syllabus shall be resubmitted.

4. The State Department of Education Accreditation Office shall return any feedback and recommendations to the local district no later than thirty (30) days following receipt of the waiver.

5. The Oklahoma Department of Career and Technology Education may submit the Nonstandard Course Waiver to the Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education for program and coursework approval or disapproval for college admissions requirements.

1 6. Framework for locally approved courses approved by local
2 school district boards of education, to include the Oklahoma
3 Academic Standards crosswalk, locally developed syllabus, and
4 district contact name shall all be made publicly available on the
5 State Department of Education website.

6 ~~N.~~ I. 1. The State Board of Education shall adopt a plan to
7 ensure that rigor is maintained in the content, teaching
8 methodology, level of expectations for student achievement, and
9 application of learning in all the courses taught to meet the
10 graduation requirements as specified in this section.

11 2. The State Board of Education shall allow as much flexibility
12 at the district level as is possible without diminishing the rigor
13 or undermining the intent of providing these courses. To accomplish
14 this purpose, the State Department of Education shall work with
15 school districts in reviewing and approving courses taught by
16 districts that are not specifically listed in subsections ~~B and C,~~
17 D, and E of this section. Options may include, but shall not be
18 limited to, courses taken by concurrent enrollment, advanced
19 placement, or correspondence, or courses bearing different titles.

20 3. The State Board of Education shall approve an advanced
21 placement computer science course to meet the requirements of course
22 competencies listed in paragraph 2 of subsection ~~B~~ D of this section
23 if the course is taken in a student's senior year and the student is
24 concurrently enrolled in or has successfully completed Algebra II.

1 4. Any student who completes the curriculum requirements of the
2 International Baccalaureate Diploma Program shall be awarded a
3 standard diploma.

4 5. Any student who successfully completes an advanced
5 mathematics or science course offered pursuant to Section 1210.404
6 of this title shall be granted academic credit toward meeting the
7 graduation requirements pursuant to paragraph 3 or 4, as
8 appropriate, of subsection C or paragraph 2 or 3 of subsection D or
9 E of this section.

10 6. The State Board of Education shall provide an option for
11 high school graduation based upon attainment of the desired levels
12 of competencies as required in tests pursuant to the provisions of
13 Section 1210.508 of this title. Such option shall be in lieu of the
14 amount of course credits earned.

15 7. The State Board of Education shall prescribe, adopt and
16 approve a promotion system based on the attainment by students of
17 specified levels of competencies in each area of the core
18 curriculum.

19 8. Technology center school districts may offer programs
20 designed in cooperation with institutions of higher education which
21 have an emphasis on a focused field of career study upon approval of
22 the State Board of Education and the independent district board of
23 education. Students in the tenth grade may be allowed to attend
24 these programs for up to one-half (1/2) of a school day and credit

1 for the units or sets of competencies required in paragraphs 3, 4,
2 6, and 7 of subsection C or paragraphs 2, 3, 6, and 7 of subsection
3 ~~B or D~~ or E of this section shall be given if the courses are taught
4 by a teacher certified in the secondary subject area; provided,
5 credit for units or sets of competencies pursuant to subsection ~~B C,~~
6 D, or E of this section ~~shall be approved~~ are subject to approval
7 for college admission requirements.

8 ~~5.~~

9 9. a. If a student enrolls in a concurrent course, the
10 school district shall not be responsible for any costs
11 incurred for that course, unless the school district
12 does not offer enough course selection during the
13 student's secondary grade years to allow the student
14 to receive the courses needed to meet the graduation
15 requirements of this section. If the school district
16 does not offer the necessary course selection during
17 the student's secondary grade years, it shall be
18 responsible for the cost of resident tuition at an
19 institution in The Oklahoma State System of Higher
20 Education, fees, and books for the concurrent
21 enrollment course, and providing for transportation to
22 and from the institution to the school site.

23 b. It is the intent of the Legislature that for students
24 enrolled in a concurrent enrollment course which is

1 paid for by the school district pursuant to this
2 paragraph, the institution charge only the
3 supplementary and special service fees that are
4 directly related to the concurrent enrollment course
5 and enrollment procedures for that student. It is
6 further the intent of the Legislature that fees for
7 student activities and student service facilities,
8 including the student health care and cultural and
9 recreational service fees, not be charged to such
10 students.

11 ~~6. Credit for the units or sets of competencies required in~~
12 ~~subsection B or D of this section shall be given when such units or~~
13 ~~sets of competencies are taken prior to ninth grade if the teachers~~
14 ~~are certified or authorized to teach the subjects for high school~~
15 ~~credit and the required rigor is maintained.~~

16 ~~7. The three units or sets of competencies in mathematics~~
17 ~~required in subsection B or D of this section shall be completed in~~
18 ~~the ninth through twelfth grades. If a student completes any~~
19 ~~required courses or sets of competencies in mathematics prior to~~
20 ~~ninth grade, the student may take any other mathematics courses or~~
21 ~~sets of competencies to fulfill the requirement to complete three~~
22 ~~units or sets of competencies in grades nine through twelve after~~
23 ~~the student has satisfied the requirements of subsection B or D of~~
24 ~~this section.~~

1 ~~8. The one-half (1/2) unit or set of competencies in personal~~
2 ~~financial literacy required in subsection B or D of this section~~
3 ~~shall be completed in the tenth, eleventh, or twelfth grade to~~
4 ~~fulfill the requirements for graduation.~~

5 ~~9. All units or sets of competencies required for graduation~~
6 ~~may be taken in any sequence recommended by the school district.~~

7 ~~0. As a condition of receiving accreditation from the State~~
8 ~~Board of Education, all students in grades nine through twelve shall~~
9 ~~enroll in a minimum of six periods, or the equivalent in block~~
10 ~~scheduling or other scheduling structure that allows for instruction~~
11 ~~in sets of competencies, of rigorous academic and/or rigorous~~
12 ~~vocational courses each day, which may include arts, vocal and~~
13 ~~instrumental music, speech classes, and physical education classes.~~

14 ~~P.~~ 1. 10. Academic and vocational-technical courses designed
15 to offer sets of competencies integrated or embedded within the
16 courses that provide for the teaching and learning of the
17 appropriate skills and knowledge in the subject matter standards, as
18 adopted by the State Board of Education, may, upon approval of the
19 Board, in consultation with the Oklahoma Department of Career and
20 Technology Education if the courses are offered at a technology
21 center school district, be counted for academic credit and toward
22 meeting the graduation requirements of this section.

23 ~~2.~~ 11. Internet-based courses offered by a technology center
24 school that are taught by a certified teacher and provide for the

1 teaching and learning of the appropriate skills and knowledge in the
2 subject matter standards may, upon approval of the State Board of
3 Education and the independent district board of education, be
4 counted for academic credit and toward meeting the graduation
5 requirements of this section.

6 ~~3.~~ 12. Internet-based courses or vocational-technical courses
7 utilizing integrated or embedded skills for which no subject matter
8 standards have been adopted by the State Board of Education may be
9 approved by the Board, in consultation with the Oklahoma Department
10 of Career and Technology Education if the courses are offered at a
11 technology center school district, if such courses incorporate
12 standards of nationally recognized professional organizations and
13 are taught by certified teachers.

14 ~~4.~~ 13. Courses offered by a supplemental education organization
15 that is accredited by a national accrediting body and that are
16 taught by a certified teacher and provide for the teaching and
17 learning of the appropriate skills and knowledge in the subject
18 matter standards may, upon approval of the State Board of Education
19 and the school district board of education, be counted for academic
20 credit and toward meeting the graduation requirements of this
21 section.

22 ~~Q. The State Board of Education shall provide an option for~~
23 ~~high school graduation based upon attainment of the desired levels~~
24 ~~of competencies as required in tests pursuant to the provisions of~~

~~Section 1210.508 of this title. Such option shall be in lieu of the amount of course credits earned.~~

~~R. The State Board of Education shall prescribe, adopt and approve a promotion system based on the attainment by students of specified levels of competencies in each area of the core curriculum.~~

~~S. Children who have an IEP pursuant to the IDEA, and who satisfy the graduation requirements through the individualized education program for that student shall be awarded a standard diploma.~~

~~T. 14. Students who enter the ninth grade in or prior to the 2007-08 school year who are enrolled in an alternative education program and meet the requirements of their plans leading to high school graduation developed pursuant to Section 1210.568 of this title shall be awarded a standard diploma.~~

~~U. Any student who completes the curriculum requirements of the International Baccalaureate Diploma Program shall be awarded a standard diploma.~~

~~V. Any student who successfully completes an advanced mathematics or science course offered pursuant to Section 1210.404 of this title shall be granted academic credit toward meeting the graduation requirements pursuant to paragraph 2 or 3, as appropriate, of subsection B or D of this section.~~

1 ~~W. For purposes of this section, the courses approved for~~
2 ~~college admission requirements shall be courses which are approved~~
3 ~~by the Oklahoma State Regents for Higher Education for admission to~~
4 ~~an institution within The Oklahoma State System of Higher Education.~~

5 ~~X.~~ 15. Students who have been denied a standard diploma by the
6 school district in which the student is or was enrolled for failing
7 to meet the requirements of this section may re-enroll in the school
8 district that denied the student a standard diploma following the
9 denial of a standard diploma. The student shall be provided
10 remediation or intervention and the opportunity to complete the
11 curriculum units or sets of competencies required by this section to
12 obtain a standard diploma. Students who re-enroll in the school
13 district to meet the graduation requirements of this section shall
14 be exempt from the hourly instructional requirements of Section 1-
15 111 of this title and the six-period enrollment requirements of this
16 section.

17 ~~Y.~~ J. Consistent with its existing mission and outreach, the
18 Workforce Commission, in coordination with State Department of
19 Education, shall develop a catalog of Oklahoma business labor force
20 endorsements for diploma recipients identifying entry-level
21 positions throughout the state that are available, potentially
22 hiring, in need, and fillable by students graduating with a high
23 school diploma pursuant to subsections C and F of this section. The
24 catalog shall identify the company, positions, area of the state,

1 demand for the job positions, and high school courses that would
2 create an ideal candidate graduating from an accredited Oklahoma
3 high school. The first production of the catalog shall be made
4 available to the State Department of Education for distribution to
5 public school districts by the beginning of the 2027-2028 school
6 year and shall be updated biannually.

7 K. The State Department of Education shall collect and report
8 data by school site and district on the number of students who
9 enroll in the core curriculum as provided in subsection ~~D~~ E of this
10 section. The State Board of Education, State Board of Career and
11 Technology Education, and State Regents for Higher Education shall
12 adopt a joint plan and electronically submit it to the Speaker of
13 the Oklahoma House of Representatives and the President Pro Tempore
14 of the Oklahoma State Senate by January 1, 2027, to ensure that
15 rigor is maintained in the content, teaching methodology, level of
16 expectations for student achievement, and application of learning in
17 all the courses taught to meet the graduation requirements specified
18 in subsections C, D, E, and F of this section. Such plan shall
19 include, but not be limited to, the number of nonstandard course
20 waivers submitted, rejected, and approved pursuant to subsection H
21 of this section, and graduation rates for each school district.

22 SECTION 2. AMENDATORY 70 O.S. 2021, Section 11-103.6f,
23 is amended to read as follows:
24

1 Section 11-103.6f. A. Prior to September 1, 2003, the State
2 Board of Education shall adopt rules to ensure that students who
3 transfer into an Oklahoma school district from out of state after
4 the junior year of high school of the student shall not be denied,
5 due to differing graduation requirements, the opportunity to be
6 awarded a standard diploma.

7 B. The rules shall allow district boards of education to make
8 exceptions on an individual student basis to the high school
9 graduation requirements of Section 11-103.6 of this title for such
10 students who would be unable to meet the specific graduation
11 requirements without extending the date of graduation. Each
12 district board of education that grants exceptions pursuant to this
13 subsection shall report to the State Department of Education on or
14 before July 1 of each year the number of students granted exceptions
15 and reasons for the exceptions.

16 C. By December 1, 2015, the State Board of Education shall
17 adopt rules requiring school district boards of education to waive
18 the Oklahoma history high school graduation requirements of Section
19 11-103.6 of this title for children of military families as defined
20 in the Interstate Compact on Educational Opportunity for Military
21 Children, set forth in Section 510.1 of this title, who transition
22 with the military from another state and who have satisfactorily
23 completed a similar state history class or other one-half (1/2) unit
24 or set of competencies in history or citizenship skills in another

1 state. The school district board of education may also waive the
2 Oklahoma History high school graduation requirements for a student
3 who meets the criteria provided in this subsection if the student
4 completes a project or writes a paper, without the assistance of
5 artificial intelligence, subject to approval of the school district,
6 that demonstrates competencies and knowledge of Oklahoma history or
7 United States Government.

8 SECTION 3. REPEALER 70 O.S. 2021, Section 11-103.6, as
9 last amended by Section 166, Chapter 452, O.S.L. 2024 (70 O.S. Supp.
10 2025, Section 11-103.6), is hereby repealed.

11 SECTION 4. REPEALER 70 O.S. 2021, Section 11-103.6, as
12 last amended by Section 1, Chapter 384, O.S.L. 2024 (70 O.S. Supp.
13 2025, Section 11-103.6), is hereby repealed.

14 SECTION 5. This act shall become effective July 1, 2026.

15 SECTION 6. It being immediately necessary for the preservation
16 of the public peace, health or safety, an emergency is hereby
17 declared to exist, by reason whereof this act shall take effect and
18 be in full force from and after its passage and approval.

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20 60-2-17601 SW 05/06/26
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